

you will find installers for different flavours and versions of Linux. The source code is also available for download.

Google Talk

Unfortunately, Google Talk is not available for Linux right now, but Google officially says that other IM clients can be used to chat with the Google Talk contacts with a Google Talk id. At least Google says it officially. And that's a good thing. You can refer to <http://www.google.com/talk/otherclients.html>, which will guide you towards setting up other chat clients to access Google Talk accounts.

Gmail or Google Chat is a Web browser-based IM protocol. When you log in to your Gmail account, you will see, towards the left corner of your browser window, a list of your Gmail contacts with whom you can chat by simply clicking on their name. This is a really handy feature, be it in Linux or Windows! If your IM clients are not working for any reason, you can simply sign in to your e-mail account on your browser and start chatting!

7.5.2 Skype

Skype is an IM and free PC-to-PC calling application. You can also call landlines or mobile phones, for a fee though. What is special is that anyone can call you on a number that Skype will assign to you, and it acts just like a real phone number—you can “pick” the call on your computer no matter where you have logged in to your account from. Skype can be downloaded from www.skype.com/download/skype/linux/

7.5.3 Internet Relay Chat (IRC)

You've probably come across “IRC” somewhere. If we proceed to explain the concept of IRC, you may be left wondering: “So what is the difference between this IRC thingy and the IM that I use?” So, we'll just say this: IRC was a very early way of Instant Messaging, but it was not focused as a peer-to-peer (one individual to another) application, but it was aimed at group chatting. There were specific IRC chat rooms or servers, where an IRC user could just join